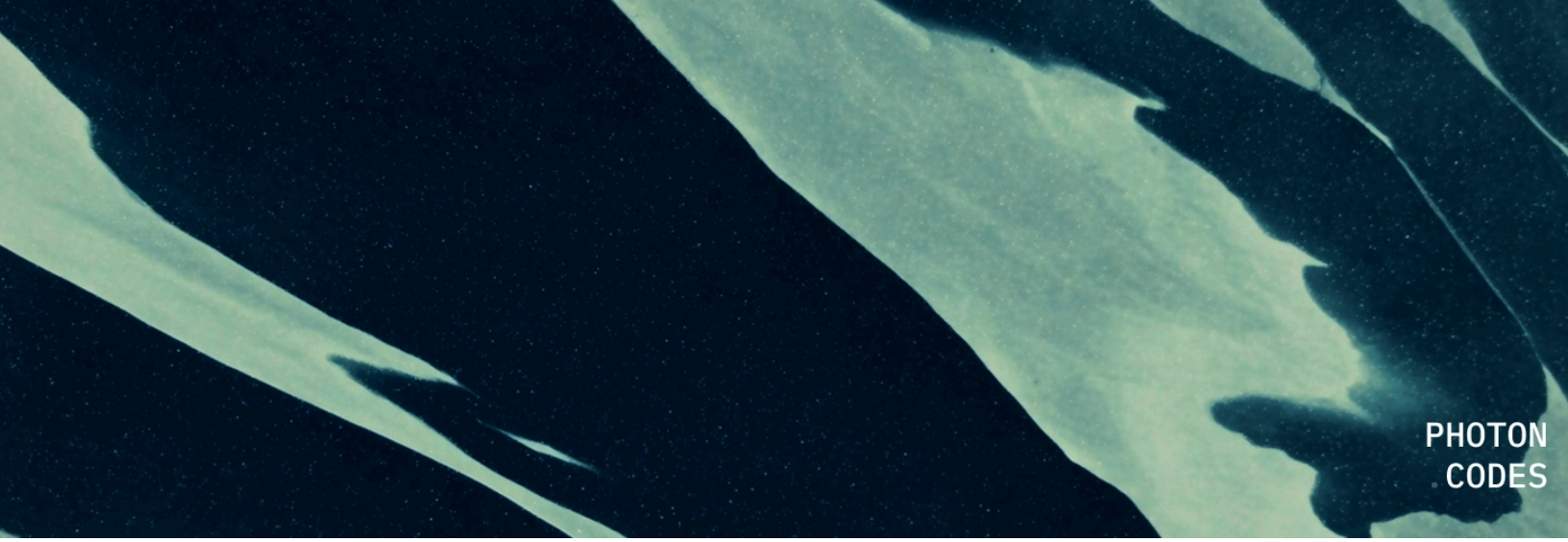


Hackathon Guidelines for Photon 2.0

🏆 Track: Build a Messaging Agent using Photon 2.0

A track for builders who see a future where AI coexists with us

We're inviting teams who believe AI isn't a utility tool but a being that lives with us - present in our conversations, attuned to context, and trusted to act with taste. Build agents that don't merely assist, but participate. Shape a future where human intention and machine intuition compound.

> 🚀 **New: the Photon 2.0 beta goes live @Thursday at photon.co/beta, and it's free to use.** Give your agent a phone number and a native presence everywhere people already talk: iMessage, SMS, RCS, WhatsApp, Telegram, email, and phone calls. Be among the first teams to build on it.

What you can build

- Agents that join human-to-human conversations naturally to suggest, support, or participate
- AI companions that understand social context, emotion, and tone
- Multi-agent systems that collaborate with humans and each other toward shared goals

- Agents that talk: voice agents on a Photon phone number that answer and place real calls, then keep the conversation going over text
- Tools that let agents seamlessly exist across interfaces, from iMessage and SMS to WhatsApp, Telegram, email, and phone calls

☝️ 🪜 Examples

Requirements

Build on the Photon 2.0 beta and ship where people already live:

- Photon 2.0 beta - Photon's open source framework that brings agents to every messaging channel. Sign up at the dashboard, create a project, and add the channels you want. No promo code needed: the beta is free to use.
- **Texting:** connect your agent to iMessage through the dashboard, and add SMS, RCS, WhatsApp, Telegram, or email if you want more reach. iMessage is still the flagship channel for text agents.
- **Voice:** phone calls run on an SMS number, not on iMessage. Add an SMS number to your project, set up a Voice profile, and connect it over SIP to Retell, ElevenLabs, LiveKit, or Twilio. Calls and group chat on iMessage both need a dedicated iMessage line, so for the hackathon, build voice on SMS.
- Docs: Photon 2.0 beta docs (still being written) and cookbooks with step-by-step voice setup for Retell, ElevenLabs, LiveKit, and Twilio. SDK reference: https://photon.codes/docs/spectrum-ts/introduction